NYPA RFP Q&A: What It Means for KMS

RFP Q26-7821RJM | Prepared by Johurul Hassan Mazumder | 24 October 2026 (IST)

NYPA has answered other vendors' questions on the Knowledge Management RFP (238 questions, including the 22 Oct update). The points below affect our bid and the product. Q&A numbers refer to NYPA's response sheet (Attachment 5).

1. Proposal and contract

Point	What it means for us	Q&A #
SOC 2 Type II report	Required **with the proposal**. A penetration test is not accepted as a substitute. Without it the bid is at risk regardless of product features.	33, 143, 156
No offshore resources	Only US-based people may work on the project, even on tasks that don't touch NYPA data. Remote work is fine within NYPA's time zone; no onsite work is expected.	71-74, 14
Deadline: 4 Nov 2026	Submission moved from 28 Oct to 4 Nov (one-week extension).	82, 147
Working demo	Due within 2 weeks of notification. Must be a live, working product (no slides or screenshots). NYPA data is not needed.	84, 173
Performance figures	Vendors must include **their own performance statistics** in the proposal (search, AI answers, indexing, sync). We need measured numbers, not estimates.	230
Bid on one area only	We may bid only on the Enterprise Knowledge Platform; each area is priced and evaluated separately.	16, 119
Commercial terms	3-year term at a fixed price. Cloud hosting and software licences must be included in our price.	11, 77, 78, 68
Supplier diversity	Goals are 30% MWBE / 6% SDVOB of the **total** contract value. Only NYS-certified firms count. A waiver is possible with documented good-faith effort.	1, 39, 50, 89
Contract exceptions	Any exception to NYPA terms (e.g. $10M liability insurance) must be submitted as a redline; significant exceptions can cost the award.	20
Start date	January 2027, on an expedited timeline; NYPA welcomes our proposed milestones.	13

2. What the product must do

Point	What it means for us	Q&A #
Knowledge graph (our strength)	NYPA has **no knowledge graph today** and expects the vendor to design and run a new one. KMS already has one, so this is a differentiator to show in the proposal and demo.	227
Content is PPT, PDF and video	NYPA's ~1,500 in-scope files are mostly PowerPoint, PDF and MP4, with VTT transcripts. **KMS does not yet process PowerPoint or video**; this is the main build gap.	44, 132, 185
Large videos	~300 hours of recordings today, +120 hours a year; single files up to 8 GB.	62, 188
OCR on images	Image text must be extracted (most images are unprocessed today).	96, 97, 115
Existing taxonomy	NYPA uses Progress Semaphore (~2,600 terms, 8 levels, SKOS export); ~250,000 items are already tagged. KMS must import and use it rather than replace it.	113, 128, 177
Microsoft Copilot access	KMS content must be reachable from Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat through an API, MCP or connector.	47
Microsoft environment	M365 GCC tenant with Entra ID sign-in. This fits our current Microsoft integration.	108, 179

Point	What it means for us	Q&A #
Update speed	NYPA asked for changes to appear within 5 minutes (another answer says scheduled sync is acceptable).	99, 46
Scale and performance	~2,600 users, 100 at peak; search and AI answers in under 10 seconds.	48, 69
Environments and recovery	4 environments (Dev, Test, QA, Prod); recovery within 48 hours.	67, 100, 101
AI data rules	NYPA data may not be used to train AI models. AI providers and open-source components are approved case by case, so our AI provider needs NYPA approval.	180, 32, 192
Human review of AI content	Required for all AI-generated content, but kept light; stricter for critical content.	195
SharePoint first	Only SharePoint is needed at launch; OpenText Content Server and ServiceNow can follow later.	66, 235

3. Less work than expected

Point	What it means for us	Q&A #
No migration or cleanup	Content stays where it is; NYPA does its own cleanup, taxonomy and metadata work.	58, 160, 105, 106, 234
Smaller scope	No retention or legal-hold features, no structured (SQL) data, English only, no CEII-restricted content, duplicates not a concern.	181, 184, 103, 102, 194